

Mercury

80
Hg

The only metal that is liquid at room temperature, mercury melts at -38.8°C (-37.9°F) and is solid below this temperature. Pure mercury is easily refined by heating its minerals, such as cinnabar. It is highly poisonous and its use is limited.

ATOMIC MASS 200.592

STATE Liquid

DISCOVERY Around 1500 BCE



**Chunk of cinnabar,
an ore of mercury**



The chemical symbol for mercury, Hg, comes from "hydrargyrum", a Latin term that means "water silver".

**Liquid form of
pure mercury**

